

CAD 8 Communications Guide

Purpose: Explain how CAD 8 components communicate across the stack (frontend, backend, services), with readable flow charts, essential file locations, and patterns usable for knowledge transfer and onboarding.

Audience: Developers, integrators, support staff, and QA working with CAD 8.

1) System overview

CAD 8 is a multi-component system that communicates via:

- HTTP/REST APIs (Genero 4GL backends and service endpoints)
- WebSockets (NG911 EIDO conveyance)
- Valkey (Redis-compatible) pub/sub and queues for client signaling and map updates
- Web Services (SOAP/WS style) for legacy integrations
- CEFSharp browser bridge for passing data from the C# frontend to embedded web UIs

High-level components:

- Backend service modules (Genero 4GL, Python, C)
 - Frontend desktop apps (C#, WPF) and embedded browser UIs (CEFSharp)
 - NG911 EIDO WebSocket server and conveyance workers (.NET)
 - Valkey integration and signaling library (Genero 4GL + C)
 - Specialized frontend web apps (Response Recommendation Config, React Reports)
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2) Communication channels

2.1 REST/HTTP

- Backend exposes REST endpoints in multiple modules:
- BSS REST API (Versioned, GET/POST handlers)
- Fire CAD Response Recommendations (GET/POST/PUT/DELETE endpoints)
- RapidSOS, Hospitals, etc. utility endpoints
- Frontend and web apps call these endpoints via `HttpClient` (C#) or `axios` (JS).
- Shared request headers standardize identity, transaction tracing, and context.

Flow: Frontend → REST API → Handler → DB/Valkey → JSON response

```

flowchart LR
    A[Frontend (C# or Web)] -->|HTTP GET/POST| B[BSS/FireCAD REST API]
    B --> C{Route by path/version}
    C -->|GET| D[handle_v1_get_request / Fire GET handlers]
    C -->|POST/PUT/DELETE| E[POST/PUT/DELETE handlers]
    D --> F[(Database/Valkey)]
    E --> F
    F --> G[JSON Response]
    G --> A
    
```

Key files:

- Backend/bss/rest_api/src/bss_rest_api.4gl
- Backend/bss/rest_api/src/bss_rest_api_fire_lib.4gl
- Backend/firecad/src/cws_response_recommendations.4gl
- Backend/maxicad/src/cws_rapid_sos.4gl
- Frontend/VTMCore/Managers/RestManager.cs

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Standard headers (examples set by frontend):

- X-VTM-TransactionId (per request transaction)
 - X-VTM-WhichCad (P/F)
 - X-VTM-CurrentCall (RIN)
 - X-VTM-CurrentCallCad (call's CAD)
 - X-VTM-User , X-VTM-Device , X-VTM-DeviceType , X-VTM-OpCode , X-VTM-OpJur , X-VTM-Language
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2.2 WebSockets (NG911 EIDO)

- Dedicated WebSocket server accepts connections, upgrades HTTP to WebSocket, and routes EIDO messages.
- Configurable host/port via JSON.
- Message handlers generate or process EIDO events, subscriptions, and server requests.

Flow: Client → HTTP Listener → Upgrade → WebSocketServer → MessageHandler → EIDO events

```
flowchart TB
    A[Client] --> B[HTTPListener]
    B -->|Upgrade| C[WebSocketServer]
    C --> D[ProcessSocketAsync]
    D --> E[MessageHandler.ProcessIncomingMessage]
    E --> F[EIDOHandler / RouteEventRequest]
    F --> G[Send to subscribed clients]
```

Key files:

- cad-ent-websockets/WebSocketServer.cs
- cad-ent-websockets/Configurations/WebSocketConfig.cs
- cad-ent-websockets/Handlers/MessageHandler.cs

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- cad-ent-websockets/Handlers/EIDOHandler.cs
- vps-cad8-backend/ng911/conveyance/build/debug_server.sh

Conveyance utilities:

- cad-ng911-eido-conveyance/Handlers/MessageHandlerUtil.cs
- cad-ng911-eido-conveyance/EventLogging/EidoLogEvent.cs
- cad-ng911-eido-conveyance/Util/Constants.cs

2.3 Valkey signals (Pub/Sub, queues)

- Backend publishes CAD updates to Valkey channels and queues (e.g., map updates, monitor changes, unit/call updates).
- Frontend listens or fetches based on signals for UI updates.

Flow: Backend → Valkey publish/queue → Frontend consumption → UI update

```
flowchart LR
    A[Backend 4GL] -->|PUBLISH/LPUSH/ZADD| B[(Valkey)]
    B --> C[Frontend (C# or Web) listens/fetches]
    C --> D[Update UI (map/monitor/call)]
```

Key files:

- cad-valkey-components/valkey_api_util.4gl (connect/select/publish)
- cad-valkey-components/valkey_api.c (TLS)

Examples:

- Unit update → Publish map update (valkey_api_util.4gl)
- Call removal → Publish map update (valkey_api_util.4gl)
- Monitor changes via ZADD/EXPIRE (valkey_api_util.4gl)

2.4 Web Services (SOAP/WS)

- Legacy WS endpoints used by CAD Status Screen and other components (KeepAlive, browser status service).
- WS calls instrumented with logging and telemetry.

Key files:

- Frontend/VTMCore/Webservices/KeepAlives.cs
 - Backend/common/cadfire/cws_browsersss_services.4gl
 - Backend/common/cadfire/signal_browsersss.4gl
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2.5 CEFSharp bridge (embedded web UIs)

- Frontend passes data to embedded web apps (React/Mithril) via CEFSharp bound objects.
- Used for specialized displays like E911 chat and Reports.

Key files:

- Backend/web_browser/vesta_911_chat/README.txt
 - Backend/web_browser/vesta_911_chat/app.js
 - cad-react-reports/src/components/Report.jsx (CefSharp binding)
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3) REST endpoints and patterns

3.1 BSS REST API (Versioned routing)

Paths are parsed then routed to version handlers.

```
flowchart LR
  A[HttpServiceRequest] --> B[split_rest_url/path/query]
  B --> C[parse_request_url (root 'VWSBSSAPI')]
  C --> D{endpoint == version}
  D -->|v1 + GET| E[handle_v1_get_request]
  D -->|v1 + POST| F[handle_v1_post_request]
  E --> G[JSON response + status]
  F --> G
```

3.2 Fire CAD Response Recommendations

Endpoints (from the web app constants):

- Base: `/cadws/ws/r/app_groups/VWSUNIT/response_recommendations`
- Modifiers: `.../modifiers`
- Responses: `.../responses`
- Response Zones: `.../response_zones`
- Row order update: `.../responses/row_order/update/{fmodRin}`

Flow: Load modifiers + nested responses, manage CRUD, update row ordering.

```
sequenceDiagram
participant UI
participant REST_JS
participant FireCAD_API
UI->>REST_JS: getModifiers(respModifier, alarmLevel)
REST_JS->>FireCAD_API: GET /modifiers/{respModifier}?alarmLevel=...
FireCAD_API-->>REST_JS: 200 + modifiers[]
REST_JS->>FireCAD_API: For each modifier: GET /responses/{rin}
FireCAD_API-->>REST_JS: 200 + responses[]
REST_JS-->>UI: Combined modifiers + responses
UI->>REST_JS: addResponses / modifyResponses / deleteResponses
REST_JS->>FireCAD_API: POST/PUT/DELETE on /responses or /modifiers
FireCAD_API-->>REST_JS: Status + new RINs / data
```

4) WebSocket NG911 EIDO patterns

Server lifecycle:

- Read config, start `HttpListener` , accept connections.
- Upgrade to WebSockets and process inbound frames.
- Route event requests to subscribed clients.

```
flowchart TB
A[Start()] --> B[SetupServerConfiguration]
B --> C[Listener.Start()]
C --> D[ListenerProcessingAsync]
D --> E[AcceptContext + Upgrade]
E --> F[ProcessSocketAsync]
F --> G[MessageHandler.ProcessIncomingMessage]
G --> H[Handle Subscribe/Unsubscribe/EventRequest/Terminate]
H --> I[SendServerRequest/CloseSocketConnection]
```

5) Valkey signaling patterns

Typical operations:

- `PUBLISH` channel updates (map/call/monitor)
- Queue push/pop via `R PUSH/LPOP`
- Sorted sets for time-ordered changes (`ZADD/ZRANGEBYSCORE`)
- TTLs for ephemeral keys (`EXPIRE`), token management via hash (`HSET/HGET`)

Troubleshooting:

- Connection management and retry logic (`valkey_connect`)
 - Server info endpoint
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6) Frontend communication patterns

6.1 C# Desktop apps

- Central REST manager injects standard headers and builds URLs.
- Map Viewer uses a dedicated manager for CRUD on features (via REST).
Valkey signals prompt UI updates.

6.2 Embedded Web UIs (CEFSharp)

- Data fetched or pushed via CefSharp bound objects, then used by React/Mithril apps.

6.3 Logging and telemetry

- Unified logging with Redis telemetry options.
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7) External services and integrations

- AutoReturn (Tow requests): HTTP POST with JSON.
- Hospital services (status/lookup): REST calls with error handling.
- RapidSOS: REST setup and handlers.
- Vigilant LPR: Stubbed HTTP responses for integration testing.
- Bosun metrics: Raw HTTP POST to metrics endpoint.

8) Typical communication sequences

8.1 Response Recommendations (Config app)

```
sequenceDiagram
participant UI
participant Axios
participant FireCAD_API
UI->>Axios: setHeaders(X-VTM-*)
UI->>Axios: getModifiers(respModifier, alarmLevel)
Axios->>FireCAD_API: GET /modifiers/{respModifier}
FireCAD_API-->>Axios: 200 modifiers[]
loop per modifier
    Axios->>FireCAD_API: GET /responses/{rin}
    FireCAD_API-->>Axios: 200 responses[]
end
UI->>Axios: addResponses/modifiyResponses/deleteResponses
Axios->>FireCAD_API: POST/PUT/DELETE /responses
FireCAD_API-->>Axios: 200 + updated RINs/data
```

8.2 Map Feature Delete (Desktop)

- Frontend requests delete → backend removes feature via REST → Valkey signals prompt map update.
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9) Environment & configuration

- NG911 WebSocket build script: env vars `$CADDIR` , `$DOTNET_ROOT` .
 - Valkey settings: server address/ports, DB numbers (mapdata/drawings/tables/signal), logging.
 - WS config: host/port/subscription expiry.
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10) Troubleshooting & observability

- Logging: Frontend VTMLLog and WebSocket server logger.
 - Token/rate limiting via Valkey.
 - Connection health with KeepAlives and Valkey reconnect logic.
 - Local socket/http test tools.
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11) Essential files index (by topic)

Backend REST: `bss_rest_api.4gl`, `bss_rest_api_fire_lib.4gl`,
`cws_response_recommendations.4gl`

External integrations: `autoreturn.4gl`, `cws_hospital_util.4gl`, `cws_rapid_sos.4gl`,
`vlpr_stub.4gl`, `bosun_services.4gl`

Valkey: `valkey_api_util.4gl`, `valkey_api.c`

WebSockets: `WebSocketServer.cs`, `MessageHandler.cs`, `EIDOHandler.cs`

Frontend: RestManager.cs, DynamicFeaturesDataManager.cs, Report.jsx, rest.jsx

Tools: socket_server.py, socket_client.py, http_server.py

12) Practices and tips

- Include `X-VTM-TransactionId` in requests.
 - Use `X-VTM-WhichCad` to distinguish Police/Fire contexts.
 - Handle 4xx/5xx gracefully and parse error payloads.
 - Validate WebSocket subscription ownership; handle closures.
 - Select correct Valkey DB before operations; log/retry on failures.
 - Use unified logging and telemetry as appropriate.
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13) Glossary

RIN, Valkey, EIDO, BSS, CEFSharp

14) Example request headers

```
X-VTM-Language: e
X-VTM-User: VTEST
X-VTM-Device: VTEST
X-VTM-DeviceType: W
X-VTM-OpCode: VT
X-VTM-OpJur: 1
X-VTM-WhichCad: P
X-VTM-TransactionId: abc123
X-VTM-CurrentCall: 123456
X-VTM-CurrentCallCad: P
```

15) References & resources

- BSS REST API source: `Backend/bss/rest_api/src/bss_rest_api.4gl`
- Fire CAD Response Recommendations API: `Backend/firecad/src/cws_response_recommendations.4gl`
- Valkey API docs: `cad-valkey-components/valkey_api_util.4gl`
- NG911 WebSocket server: `cad-ent-websockets/WebSocketServer.cs`
- Frontend REST manager: `Frontend/VTMCore/Managers/RestManager.cs`

End of Guide